PAWPOLLER · GETTING STARTED GUIDE

Instagram

Track views/reach/likes/comments/saves and post photos to Instagram.

Analytics + Posting | Involved Setup

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- A Business or Creator Instagram account
- A free Meta developer app — the same one Threads uses, if you have that too
- A long-lived access token

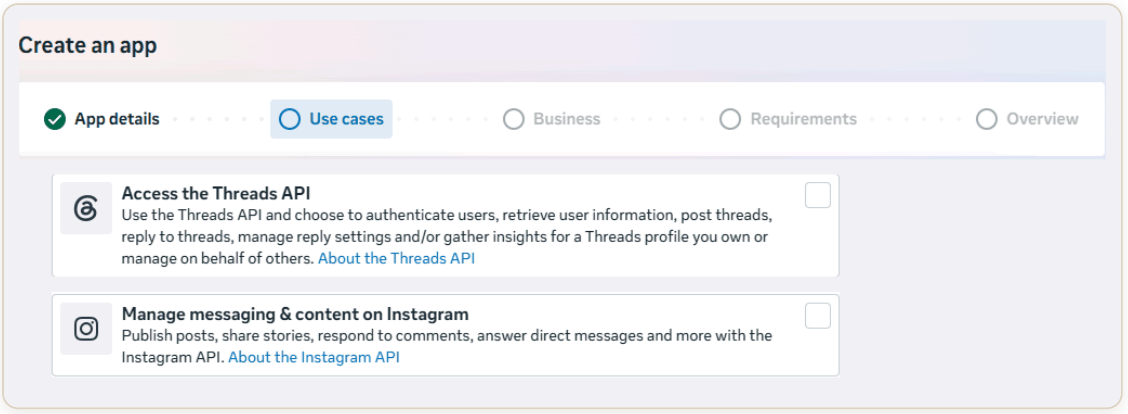
STEP BY STEP

1 Switch to a professional account

In the Instagram app: **Settings** → **Account type and tools** → **Switch to professional account** (Business or Creator). Personal accounts can't use the API. You can skip connecting a Facebook Page.

2 Create (or open) a Meta developer app

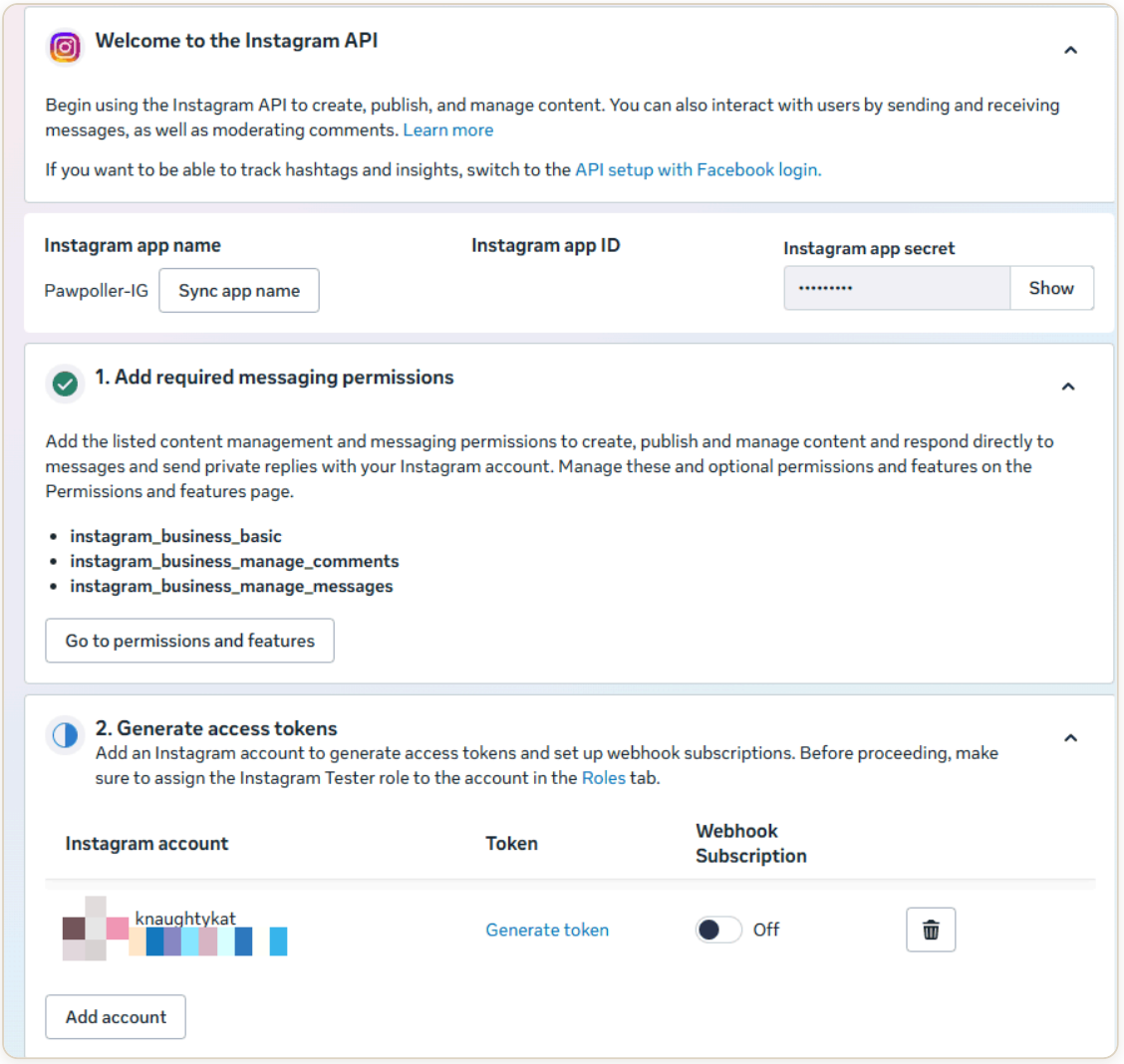
On **My Apps** press **Create app**. Name it anything, and on the **Use cases** step tick **Manage messaging & content on Instagram** (tick *Access the Threads API* too if you want Threads). No business portfolio is needed; finish the wizard. Already have the app? Open it and use **Add use cases**. developers.facebook.com/apps ↗



Create an app: the Use cases step, with Access the Threads API and Manage messaging & content on Instagram

3 Open the Instagram use case → API setup with Instagram login

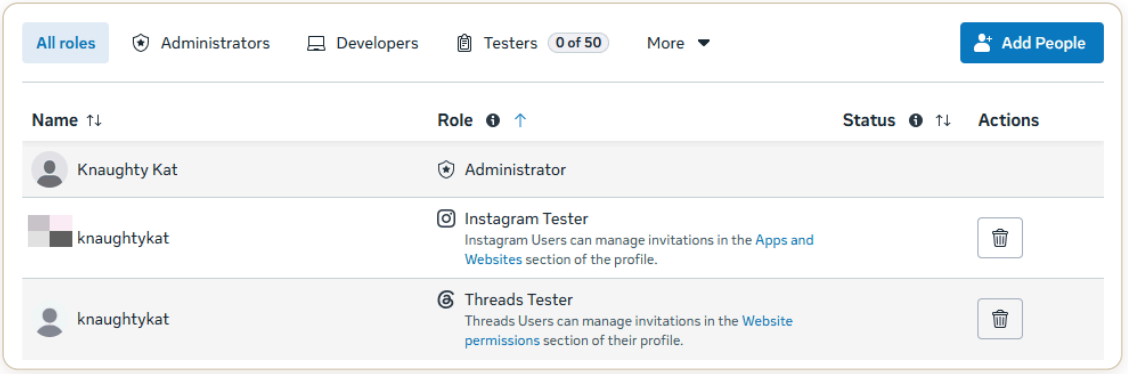
Dashboard → **Use cases** → **Customize** next to *Manage messaging & content on Instagram* → left tab **API setup with Instagram login**. Not *with Facebook login* — that one needs a Facebook Page. Meta's welcome box says to switch for insights; ignore it, PawPoller's stats work here.



API setup with Instagram login: app name and id, section 1 messaging permissions, section 2 Generate access tokens with one tester account and a Generate token link

4 Add yourself as an Instagram Tester

App roles → **Roles** → **Add People** → pick **Instagram Tester** under *Additional roles* → your Instagram username. Then accept the invite in Instagram: **Settings** → **Apps and websites** → **Tester invites**. Until you accept, the token step will not list your account.



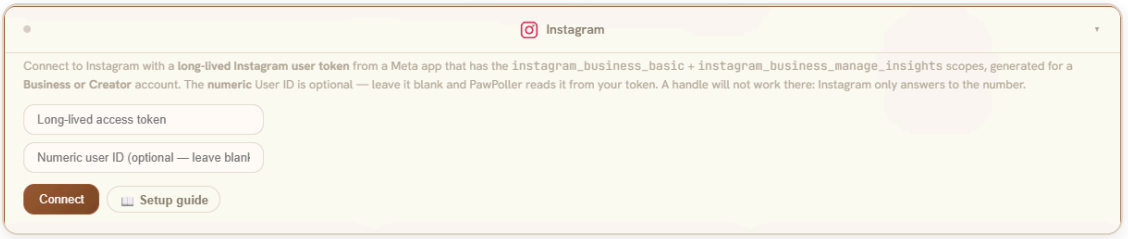
App roles: one Administrator, one Instagram Tester and one Threads Tester, with the Add People button

5 Generate the token

Back on **API setup with Instagram login**, section **2. Generate access tokens**: press **Add account** if yours is not listed, then **Generate token**. Approve everything it asks for — the app asks for the basic, insights, publishing, comments and messages scopes in one go — and copy the whole token. Skip sections 1, 3 and 5: messaging permissions, webhooks and App Review are not needed.

6 Connect in PawPoller

Settings → Platforms → Instagram: paste the token, leave the user ID blank, press **Connect**. PawPoller reads your username back from the token — check it is the account you meant.



PawPoller Settings, Instagram card: access token, optional user id, Connect

WHERE IT GOES IN PAWPOLLER

Settings → Instagram → Access token (user id optional — leave blank)

KEEPING IT ALIVE

Long-lived tokens last ~60 days. PawPoller auto-refreshes it while polling. If it lapses, generate a fresh token in section 2 of *API setup with Instagram login* and paste it back in — the app, tester role and use case all stay valid.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Do the whole setup on a **desktop** (not mobile) in **Microsoft Edge — or any browser that is NOT Chrome**. Chrome reliably breaks Meta's developer dashboard and token generator: the flow silently fails or the token never appears. Edge/Firefox work.
- The **Permissions and features** table is about App Review. On the app this guide was written from, `instagram_business_manage_insights` and `instagram_business_content_publish` were never "added" there and stats arrive anyway: the token generator asks for all five Instagram scopes regardless. Add them if you like; it costs nothing.
- Every Instagram post **requires a photo** — there are no text-only posts. Instagram fetches the image from a public address, and PawPoller finds it one: your own server if you have one, otherwise the PawPoller relay (a public PawPoller server hosts the picture for 15 minutes), otherwise a temporary tunnel from your PC. Nothing to set up; see **Settings → Posting → Instagram image host** to switch either off or to download the tunnel helper.
- Leave the app **Unpublished**. Development mode with your own account needs no App Review, and the Publish button stays greyed out until you add a privacy policy — you do not need one. A public app for other users would need review and would likely be rejected for adult content.